

just like the Gakutensoku, move his head and arms. But a truly beneficial humanoid robot implementation was yet to come and these were still ornamental advancements.

Harder, better, faster, stronger

In 1950, Alan Turing devised the Turing test as a means to determine whether or not a machine has the ability to think for itself. And throughout the decade, Turing and his contemporaries did some remarkable work in computing and artificial intelligence.

The first industrial robot, the Unimate (for ‘universal automation’) was created by George Devol in 1954 and patented in 1961. The foundation of Unimation, regarded as the world’s first robot manufacturing company, by Joseph F. Engelberger and George Devol in 1956 and the patent grant in 1961 is popularly regarded as the foundation of modern robotics. Unimate was actually used by General Motors in a plant in Trenton, New Jersey to lift hot pieces of die cast metal and stack them up.

The 1960s saw a lot of interest in robotics as an academic pursuit, as a consequence of the industrial robotics advancements of the 1950s. The world



Early UNIMATE model